Transportation Solutions Operating Benchmark

SUBVERTICAL LENS	
	Four models require separate estimates: railcar leasing, locomotive leasing, airport GSE leasing and outsourced yard logistics. Asset lessors earn higher margins with heavier reinvestment; yard logistics is labor-led, lower-margin and much lighter-capital.

METRIC	ESTIMATE	ASSERTION	CONFIDENCE
Revenue growth	Railcar **4%**; Loco **6%**; GSE **8%**; Yard **7%**	Railcar growth is held to 4% because mature fleets depend mainly on rate, utilization and measured additions; locomotives receive 6% for modernization demand. GSE and yard services receive 8% and 7% for outsourcing, electrification and new-site wins.	LOW
EBITDA margin	Railcar **58%**; Loco **62%**; GSE **30%**; Yard **14%**	Railcar and locomotive estimates remain high because lease revenue sits on long-lived assets; the 62% locomotive estimate is normalized below Akiem's roughly 68% result. GSE carries workshop costs, while yard services are labor-led.	MEDIUM
Maintenance capex / revenue	Railcar **18%**; Loco **18%**; GSE **14%**; Yard **4%**	Railcar and locomotive estimates reflect overhaul, replacement, compliance and ERTMS work; GSE's 14% reflects refurbishment, batteries and workshop support. Yard services require only tractors and technology at 4%.	MEDIUM
Customer tenor INITIAL / EFFECTIVE	Railcar **4 / 9 yrs**; Loco **7 / 12 yrs**; GSE **5 / 9 yrs**; Yard **3 / 7 yrs**	Initial terms lengthen with asset value, approval burden and mobilization complexity, making locomotives longest and yard contracts shortest. Effective tenure is longer because fleets, airport packages and embedded yard operations are commonly renewed or refreshed.	LOW
Utilization exposure	Railcar **Moderate**; Loco **Moderate**; GSE **Moderate-High**; Yard **High**	Rail exposure is Moderate because leased deployment matters but assets can be redeployed across long economic lives. GSE adds station activity and spare-fleet risk, while yard services are High because contribution depends on productive labor hours.	LOW
New-unit / customer payback	Railcar **9 yrs**; Loco **10 yrs**; GSE **5.5 yrs**; Yard **1.5 yrs**	Rail assets receive nine-to-ten-year paybacks because high upfront cost must be recovered over multiple placements and residual value matters. GSE is cheaper but service-heavy at 5.5 years, while yard launch spend can recover in about 1.5 years.	LOW
B2B vs B2C	All models **Predominantly B2B**	All four models are predominantly B2B because contractual buyers are rail operators, public authorities, airports, ground handlers, industrial firms and logistics providers. The benchmarked operations have no meaningful direct consumer revenue.	LOW

Directional framework shown where a point estimate is unsupported.

Transportation Solutions Operating Benchmark

SUBSECTOR CATEGORIES	Railcar leasing	Locomotive leasing	Airport GSE leasing	Yard logistics
	VTG	Akiem	Air Rail / TCR	Lazer Logistics

VTG

RAILCAR LEASING

Reference data. 2024 operating cash flow was EUR405m and fixed-asset investment EUR536m, mainly new wagons and maintenance; tank-wagon utilization stayed high, intermodal utilization softened and rental pricing was positive. Customers hire wagons medium-to-long term, including a cited 10-year agreement, and are industrial shippers, rail operators and logistics firms. Standalone leasing EBITDA, sustaining capex and unit payback are undisclosed.

Business. Leases and manages European freight wagons for industrial shippers and rail operators.

Economics. Unit: earning wagon; revenue: recurring lease plus services. Customers avoid capital and secure compliant, cargo-specific capacity.

Akiem

LOCOMOTIVE LEASING

Reference data. 2021: 600-plus locomotives, 46 passenger trains, EUR220m revenue and EUR150m EBITDA, or roughly 68%. A EUR1.52bn 2026 refinancing, major OEM orders and ERTMS upgrades on about 250 locomotives support expansion. Customers include carriers, manufacturers and local authorities; weighted tenor, utilization, sustaining capex and payback are undisclosed.

Business. Leases and maintains locomotives and some passenger rolling stock across Europe.

Economics. Unit: locomotive under lease/full service. Operators outsource scarce, compliant traction.

Lazer Logistics

YARD LOGISTICS

Reference data. EQT reports 550-plus sites, 5,000 employees, 6,000 fleet assets and 9m annual service hours. Lazer expanded through acquisitions and serves logistics, manufacturing, food, retail and consumer-goods companies. Its labor-led site programs are embedded but rebiddable; organic growth, EBITDA, contract tenure, labor utilization, sustaining capex and site-launch payback are undisclosed.

Business. Runs warehouse and industrial yards using drivers, equipment, processes and technology.

Economics. Unit: site contract/service hour. Recurring site and labor revenue solves trailer-flow bottlenecks.

Air Rail

AIRPORT GSE LEASING

Reference data. Air Rail expanded from 180 units in 2014 to 4,700-plus by March 2026 across about 60 airports and eight countries; 68% of motorized units were electric. It serves airports, airlines and handlers through rental, maintenance, parts, resale and reconditioning. Segment revenue, EBITDA, sustaining capex, contract tenure, utilization and payback are undisclosed.

Business. AIR RAIL, S.L. leases, maintains and refurbishes airport GSE; it also has rail activities.

Economics. Unit: deployed GSE/station package. Rental, maintenance, parts and resale solve airline/handler capex and uptime needs. Airport service embeds relationships; rebids and transfer friction cause churn.

TCR

AIRPORT GSE LEASING

Reference data. TCR has 44,000-plus assets, 100-plus workshops, about 1,000 technicians and 200-plus airports. GIP describes long-term customer relationships; TCR provides multi-year fleet planning, refurbishment, electrification, fleet right-sizing and used-equipment resale for handlers, airlines and airports. EBITDA, sustaining capex, weighted tenor, paid utilization and unit payback are undisclosed.

Business. Rents, maintains, refurbishes and electrifies GSE for airlines, handlers and airports.

Economics. Unit: GSE/airport fleet package. Full-service rent and lifecycle services solve turnaround uptime and capital needs.